

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4**PART A Group Interaction**

Below is an extract from a webpage about funding a journey to the moon:

Digital Memory Boxes

A decade from now, if all goes well, a spacecraft with a high-tech drill will land at the South Pole of the moon. There, it will drill up to 100 feet down into the surface and collect rock samples to bring back to Earth. These samples will hopefully answer questions like “What are the origins of the moon? ... Is the moon suitable for a permanent manned base for space exploration?”

Before the spacecraft leaves, it will bury a two-part time capsule: a public part, full of Earth's history, and a private part, full of “digital memory boxes” created by individuals and schools.

British engineer, David Iron, who came up with the plan said, “We have carried out research and been quite surprised how keen people are. School kids think the idea of having a bit of themselves on the moon is fantastic.”

By donating HK\$1000 you can be one of the first to reserve yourself a Digital Memory Box. Think of it like an iPod or memory stick: into your memory box, you will be able to upload whatever digital information you want: a personal message, a photo, a family tree, a poem, a video, your favourite song...the choice is yours! Millions of individual memory boxes, belonging to people and schools all over the world, will make up the private archive – to be buried deep inside the moon.

Your school has decided to send a digital memory box to the moon. As members of the Student Union, your group is going to discuss what to put inside your school's memory box. You may want to talk about:

- the purpose or theme of your memory box
- things your school could put inside
- how to get as many students and teachers involved as possible
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. What do you remember about your primary school?
2. What are your best memories from primary school?
3. Do you have a special photo that reminds you of a happy time?
4. What would you put inside your personal memory box to send to the moon?
5. Would you pay a thousand Hong Kong dollars to send a digital memory box to the moon?
6. What do you think should be put inside the public time capsule on the moon?
7. What is your earliest memory from your childhood?
8. Do you think the Internet is changing how we remember information?